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UAE sets base price for e-smoking liquids

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The UAE Ministry of Finance has announced a new minimum excise price of Dh1 per millilitre (mL) for liquids used in electronic smoking devices and tools, with the decision taking effect on September 1, 2026.

The Ministry said it had issued a decision on the minimum excise price for tobacco products and liquids used in electronic smoking devices and tools to “enhance the effectiveness of excise tax implementation and support compliance with the UAE’s tax legislation.”

The Ministry added the new decision does not change the minimum excise prices that already apply to other tobacco products.

Unified standards

The Ministry said the measure aims to “keep pace with developments in the market for excise goods and ensure the consistent application of unified standards across all categories of tobacco and electronic smoking products.”

It added that the decision “supports tax compliance and helps limit practices that may affect the effective implementation of the excise tax.”

The UAE levies 100 per cent excise tax on all tobacco products covered under the country’s excise tax regime.

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IN FOCUS



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ARAB, MUSLIM NATIONS SLAM ISRAEL, SEEK ACTION

Gaza, West Bank actions endanger peace efforts

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

A coalition of Arab and Muslim countries has issued a strongly worded condemnation of Israel’s military actions in Gaza and escalating violations in occupied East Jerusalem and the West Bank, urging the international community to intervene to protect civilians, preserve the ceasefire process and revive efforts towards a two-state solution.

In a joint statement, the foreign ministers of the UAE, Qatar, Jordan, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Turkey, Pakistan and Indonesia denounced what they called Israel’s continued targeting of health care facilities, medical infrastructure and civilian sites in the Gaza Strip, saying the attacks had caused further loss of civilian lives, including women and children, in violation of international law and international humanitarian law.

The ministers said the continued violations amounted to a breach of Israel’s obligations under international law and the Comprehensive Plan to End the Gaza Conflict.

They said the political process had gained momentum after US President Donald Trump announced that Palestinian factions had accepted the roadmap, including provisions on the confinement of weapons. Continued military operations, they said, risked derailing that

JERUSALEM IN FOCUS

An Arab ministerial meeting in Cairo called for urgent international action to halt Israeli violations in occupied Jerusalem, reaffirming that East Jerusalem remains an integral part of the occupied Palestinian territory.

The meeting rejected policies aimed at altering the city’s Arab, Islamic and Christian identity, backed Jordan’s Hashemite Custodianship of the Islamic and Christian holy sites and warned that continued actions at Al Aqsa Mosque and other holy places threatened regional and international peace and security. Participants announced plans to launch a joint international initiative and agreed to convene a joint ministerial meeting of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation and the League of Arab States on the sidelines of next month’s UN General Assembly. — S. N. R.

process, reigniting violence and worsening Gaza’s humanitarian crisis. The ministers stressed that protecting civilians, safeguarding hospitals and humanitarian workers and ensuring the immediate, safe and unhindered delivery of humanitarian assistance throughout Gaza were legal obligations that could not be compromised under any circumstances.

Settler attacks in West Bank

They also argued that the situation in Gaza could not be viewed separately from what they described as increasing settler attacks in the occupied West Bank, the expansion of Israeli settlements and unilateral measures aimed at changing the status quo in occupied Jerusalem.

The ministers said these actions formed part of a systematic policy aimed at imposing new realities on the ground, under-

mining the prospects for a two-state solution and denying the legitimate rights of the Palestinian people. They called on the UN Security Council to assume its legal and moral responsibilities by taking practical steps to compel Israel to comply with international law and relevant UN resolutions, hold those responsible for serious violations accountable, protect civilians and help secure a permanent ceasefire.

They also reiterated their rejection of any attempt to annex occupied Palestinian territory, impose Israeli sovereignty over it or forcibly displace Palestinians, saying a just and lasting peace could only be achieved through a serious political process leading to an independent Palestinian state based on the 1967 borders, with East Jerusalem as its capital.

— With inputs from WAM
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